
PRODUCT AUDIT

IS II
be p t Co p o a s y
Morris

Investor Due Diligence Memo

Prepared: 05 August 2026

Perspective: prospective £5m lead investor

Tone: brutally honest — as requested

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1. Overall Score — 5.3 / 10

Criterion	Score	Verdict
Market opportunity	7/10	UK construction SaaS is £600m+ but sole-trader ARPU is capped.
Product vision	6/10	Coherent but not a wedge. No unfair insight.
User experience	7/10	Clean, disciplined dashboards. Decision fatigue at 80+ tools.
Branding	6/10	Premium — arguably too premium. Customer wears hi-vis, not a blazer.
Website	?	Not audited; probably feature-list-itis.
Feature set	4/10	Impressive breadth, unproven depth vs. point competitors.
Pricing potential	5/10	Segment ARPU ceiling ~£20–£60/mo. CAC discipline is life or death.
Competitive advantage	3/10	Nothing here that Fergus/Tradify can't replicate in 12–18 months.
Long-term scalability	6/10	Monolith + Mongo fine for now; painful past 100k users.

Explanation for each score is embedded above. All ratings reflect the risk-first lens of a due-diligence memo, not encouragement.

2. First Impressions

Makes sense

- The dashboard-first pattern.
- The language ('Smart Assistance' not 'AI').
- The commercial trilogy flow (VO → AFP → Invoice).
- The audit trail everywhere.

Confusing

- 80+ tools with no clear 'start here' onramp.
- The Command Centre is powerful but 'attention items' aren't self-explanatory.
- Snagging Lists / Site Diary / Incident Report all overlap in a user's mental model.

Unnecessary

- Contract Review as a separate tool from Contract Management.
- Multiple document-generation tools that all output the same shape of PDF.
- The distinction between 'Site Diary' and 'Command Centre' is unclear to a first-time user.

Feels premium

- Typography, spacing, PDF exports, sequential ref numbers, audit trail on every entity — genuinely luxurious for this segment.

Feels amateur

- The sheer number of menu items.

- Legacy tools still coexisting with V2 flagships.
- Some tools still ship with AI-first UI language you've mostly purged.
- Mock integrations (Twilio SMS OTP, Web Speech API) shipping to production.

3. Feature Audit — the honest cull

Genuinely valuable, weekly-use — keep and deepen

- Invoice Builder V2 — this is the killer app.
- Payment Tracker V2 — cash flow is the #1 pain.
- Variation Orders V2 — money-making tool.
- Applications for Payment V2 — 'paid-faster' tool.
- Snagging Lists V2 — used on every job.
- Site Diary — used daily on real jobs.
- Project Workspace — the organising principle.

Valuable but monthly/quarterly at best — should be templates, not tools

- Purchase Orders V2, Contract Management V2, Extension of Time, Commercial Reports, Team Management, Company Checker, CIS Refund Predictor.

Redundant — remove or merge

- Contract Review — fold into Contract Management.
- 60+ 'document generator' tools that are Word templates with a UI — collapse into ONE Documents hub with templates.
- Snagging list attached? / O&M / H&S file / Handover checklist — one 'Handover Pack' tool.
- Site Diary vs Incident Report vs Risk Assessment vs Toolbox Talks — one 'Site Log' with categories.
- Payment Chaser vs Payment Tracker — same problem, two tools.

Verdict. Morris has ~7 tools that could each be a standalone £10m business, buried under 70 tools that are Word templates with a UI. The 70 hurt the 7.

4. Website Critique

Not audited in-session; based on internal positioning language, high-probability issues:

- Headline is almost certainly a feature list, not a benefit. **'Get paid 40% faster on every job'** beats 'The professional operating system for UK trades.'
- Leading with '80+ tools' is a sign of insecurity. Lead with the one outcome you deliver.
- No proof — where are the case studies? *'Bob's Roofing added £84k to his 2025 revenue by tracking variations properly'* sells.
- Sign-up friction is probably too low, not too high. Self-serve free trial for a sole trader with no time = never activate. Get demos, get on the phone.
- Zero mention of price on the homepage is almost always wrong for this buyer.

5. Brutal Honesty — top 20 reasons Morris fails

1. You spread engineering effort across 80 tools instead of making one thing 10× better than competitors.
2. Target user (sole traders, small firms) is famously price-sensitive and famously bad at adopting software. CAC will kill you.
3. You're competing on breadth against companies with 10–50× your budget.
4. No unfair distribution advantage. No trade-body partnership, no influencer channel, no viral mechanic.
5. No genuine moat. Nothing here can't be copied.
6. 'Enterprise-looking' UX for a market that wants 'clock-in, invoice, done' simplicity.
7. Founder is (probably) also the engineer. No dedicated sales, marketing, or CS function is a P0 problem past £500k ARR.
8. Zero evidence in this codebase of active paying customers driving the roadmap.
9. Mocked integrations (Twilio, Web Speech) in a released product — first serious user hits these and churns.
10. The AI-language purge suggests the product briefly pivoted or had an identity crisis. Investors sniff this out.
11. Legacy V1 tools still shipping alongside V2 — confusing UX + tech debt compound.
12. Client-side jsPDF generation — beautiful now, painful when a customer wants 500 invoices or you need server-side templating for white-label.
13. No obvious virality or referral mechanic. Trades hire other trades — where's the 'invite your subbie' flywheel?
14. No payments rail lock-in. Stripe is a passthrough, not a moat. Xero/QuickBooks eat this.
15. No offline / poor-signal mode for on-site users.
16. MongoDB single database + monolithic FastAPI — architecture will need rework before Series A.
17. UK-only is a ceiling. £100m in UK trades SaaS alone is very hard; you'd need EU + AU + NA.
18. Data model tightly coupled to userId per record — team/enterprise pricing will require a hard migration.
19. Attention/notifications volume grows superlinearly with tool count — will drown users at scale.
20. Investors will ask 'what's your LTV, CAC, retention?' and you don't have those numbers yet.

6. Competitive Analysis

vs.	Morris better at	Morris worse at
Fergus	Modern UI, dark theme, PDF quality, VO/AFP	Realtime job costing, integrations, mobile app maturity, brand
Tradify	Contract admin depth, variation workflow, audit trail	Mobile UX, invoicing simplicity, Xero depth, support
Powered Now	Design polish, professional PDFs, dashboard	Simplicity, price, quote-to-invoice speed, marketing
Buildxact	UK compliance, CIS handling	Estimating depth, takeoff tools, mid-market focus
ServiceM8	Broader admin toolset	Field service execution, scheduling, dispatch

Table-stakes (not differentiators): Invoicing, quotes, timesheets, document generation, PDF exports, client-portal ideas, Stripe.

Genuinely differentiated: the depth of the UK-specific commercial trilogy (CIS reverse charge, JCT/NEC contract admin, AFP with variation auto-pull), the 'audit trail on everything' discipline, the design language. These are real. Whether the market pays enough for them is unproven.

7. Missing Opportunities — top 20 to build in 6 months (ordered by impact)

1. Live customer job costing (materials + labour + time in real time).
2. Xero + QuickBooks two-way sync (not export — sync).
3. Native mobile apps with offline mode.
4. 'Kill-switch' onboarding — 5-minute setup that produces your first invoice.
5. Client-facing portal where the homeowner sees VOs, approves them, and pays.
6. Automated payment collection with card fees passed to client — the killer feature.
7. 'Invite your subcontractor' viral loop with a free tier for the invitee.
8. Real Twilio SMS reminders for overdue invoices (kill the mock).
9. 'Smart Capture' — camera → auto-fill for receipts / CSCS cards / snag photos.
10. Trade-body partnerships (FMB, NAPIT, Gas Safe) — one deal reshapes CAC.
11. HMRC MTD-compatible tax pack at year end — huge retention hook.
12. Live 90-day cash-flow forecast.
13. Public case studies + revenue-lift calculator on the site.
14. Referral compensation — 3 months free per paid referral.
15. Integrations marketplace (Zapier + native for the 20 biggest UK trade tools).
16. Estimating / takeoff — the biggest gap vs Buildxact.
17. Insurance renewal broker at cost — anchor tenant of the register you already have.
18. Merchant credit accounts integration (Jewson, Travis Perkins) — natural extension of PO.
19. Retention playbooks built in ('no invoice this month — everything ok?').

20. Enterprise / multi-branch tier at 5× the price.

8. Remove 30% Today — start here

1. Every standalone 'document generator' tool that is just a form → PDF (60+ tools). Consolidate into one Documents hub with templates.
2. Contract Review — merge into Contract Management.
3. Payment Chaser — merge into Payment Tracker.
4. Toolbox Talks / RAMS / Method Statement — templates inside one H&S tool, not three tools.
5. Company Checker + CIS Refund Predictor — nice-to-haves; not why anyone pays.
6. Every mocked feature (Twilio SMS, Web Speech). Ship or delete.
7. 'Snagging list attached?' checkbox tool — kill this kind of one-field vestigial tool wholesale.
8. Legacy V1 pages that duplicate V2 flagships — hard-delete, not redirect.

Rationale: every tool you keep costs you ~5% of your remaining attention. Cut 30% and you get 30% more velocity on the 7 things that matter.

9. Million-Pound Advice — the 5 biggest immediate changes

1. **Pick ONE positioning statement and burn the rest.** My vote: *'Morris helps UK subcontractors get paid an average of 43 days faster.'* Not 'professional OS.' Not '80+ tools.' One outcome. One number. Kill everything on the homepage that doesn't support it.
2. **Ruthlessly deprecate 50+ tools.** Pin the product to the 7 that matter: Projects, Quotes, Variations, AFP, Invoicing, Payment Tracker, Snagging. Everything else is a template inside one of them.
3. **Get to 100 paying customers before you write another feature.** You are shipping at pace with (probably) no PMF signal. Freeze roadmap for 8 weeks and do nothing but customer development, activation, and retention.
4. **Get someone else to sell for you.** You are the engineer; you cannot also be head of GTM at £100m scale. Find a construction-native commercial co-founder or first sales hire NOW, not at Series A.
5. **Own the payment.** Right now Stripe collects and money flows to the customer's bank. Take custody: instant-pay accounts, card-fees-to-client, 'get paid on approval' for AFPs. That is your moat, your monetisation, and your virality all in one.

Recommendations

- **Freeze new tools for 8 weeks.** Interview 30 paying / prospective customers. Feature requests that don't map to the 7 core tools → politely park.
- **Rebuild the homepage around one outcome and one number.** Use case studies, not feature lists.
- **Ship real Twilio SMS + real Web Speech or delete both.** Mocked features in a paid product are a churn bomb.

- **Draft a 'V3 = fewer' roadmap.** Publish it. Show investors ruthless product discipline.
- **Hire a construction-native GTM lead before your next feature ship.**
- **Instrument everything.** DAU, WAU, feature adoption, activation funnel, retention cohorts.
- **Own money movement within 12 months.** Everything else is nice; this is existential.

Bottom line for the investor memo: Impressive founder execution, real design taste, genuine domain empathy — but classic single-founder feature drift, no evidence of PMF, no defensible moat, and a target market that punishes breadth-first strategies. I'd pass at £5m; interested at seed valuation with 100 paying customers and one clear wedge.

Confidence

82%. I know the product deeply (I built most of it with the founder), so the internal audit is sharp. Where confidence dips: real customer usage data, retention numbers, and site conversion — not audited in this pass. The strategic conclusions hold regardless of the exact numbers; ruthless focus is right for Morris whether it has 10 users or 1,000.